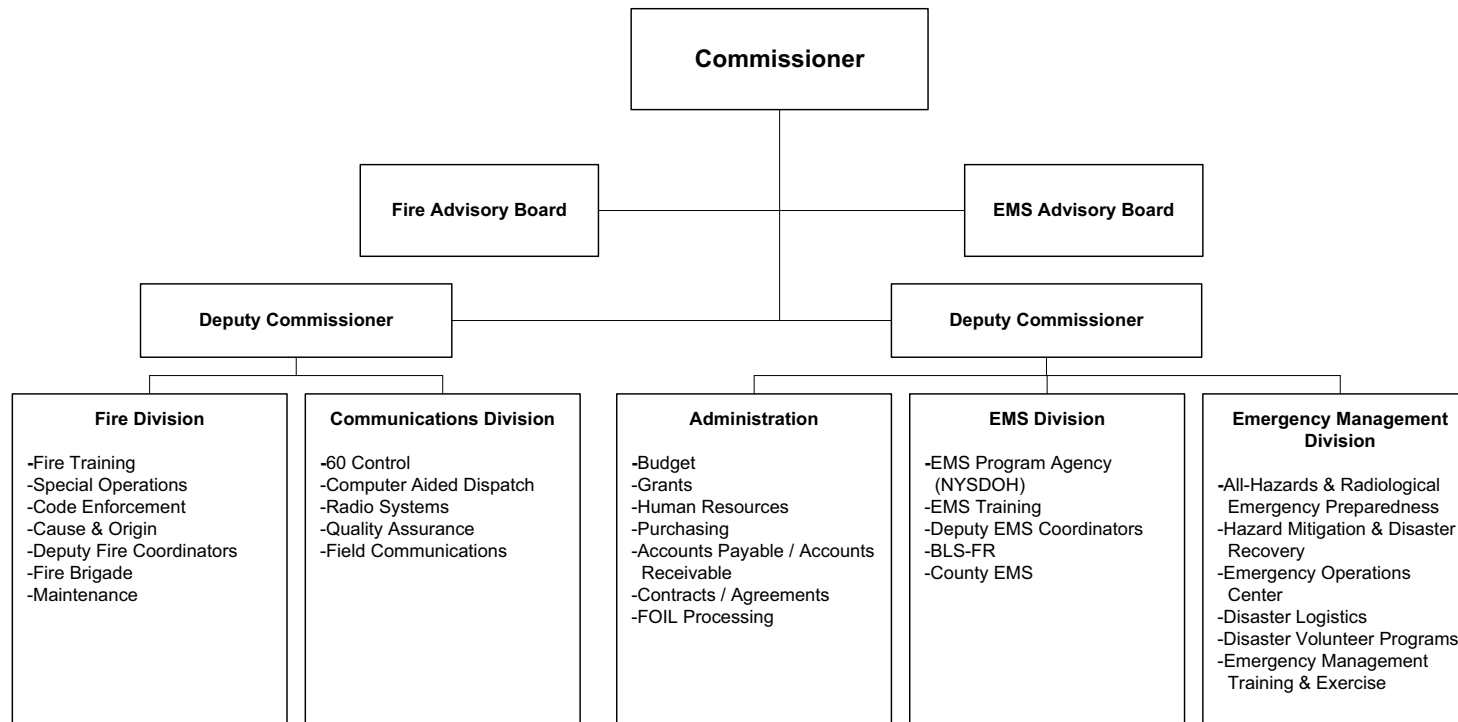


Emergency Services (20)



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Mission Statement

The mission of the Department of Emergency Services is to protect lives, property, and the environment in Westchester County through the provision of comprehensive Training, Communication Services, Mitigation, Emergency Preparedness, Response and Management to support municipalities and emergency service agencies. The Department supports first responders as we work together to build, sustain, and improve our capability to mitigate, prepare for, protect against, respond to, and recover from all natural and human caused hazards.

	2024	2025
POSITIONS		
Operating	65	67
Grants	5	5
	70	72
OPERATING BUDGET EXPENDITURES		
Personal Services	3,315,639	7,338,754
Equipment	543,130	116,700
Material & Supplies	942,272	772,056
Expenses	5,928,006	5,334,367
Interdepartmental Charges	5,180,792	5,375,052
TOTAL EXPENDITURES	15,909,839	18,936,929
OPERATING BUDGET REVENUES		
Interdepartmental	637,524	708,456
Departmental	416,389	992,865
State and Federal Aid	358,600	358,600
TOTAL REVENUES	1,412,513	2,059,921
DEPARTMENT TAX LEVY	14,497,326	16,877,008
Estimated Share of Miscellaneous Budget Items:		
Retirement Systems	716,902	1,627,712
Health Insurance and Benefits	1,128,018	2,454,414
DEPARTMENT TOTAL	16,342,246	20,959,134

The Appropriated 2024 figures in the supporting detail include all budget amendments through August 31, 2024 and Appropriations Assigned for Purchases on Order ("roll forwards") of \$621,812.

Emergency Services (20)

DEPARTMENT OF EMERGENCY SERVICES (20)

The Department of Emergency Services is responsible for several programs relating to fire and emergency medical services training and mutual aid, in addition to disaster preparedness and response. The Department of Emergency Services performs these under the following state laws and regulations.

Programs and Services

Arson Investigation, hazardous materials incident response plan

Disaster Preparedness & Emergency Management

EMS Program Agencies (REMSCO)

Emergency Communications Center/Secondary Public Safety
Answering Point

Emergency Medical Services Training and Mutual Aid

Fire Mobilization and Mutual Aid Plan

Fire Training and Coordinator

Records Management

State Law or Regulations

NYS General Municipal Law, Section 204

NYS Executive Law, Article 2-B

NYS Defense Emergency Act of 1951

NYS Public Health Law, Section 3003-A

NYS County Law, Article 6-A

21 NYCRR Chapter LX New York State 911 Board

NYS County Law, Article 5, Section 223-b

NYS General Municipal Law, Section 209

19 NYCRR Part 205 Fire Mobilization & Mutual Aid Plan

NYS County Law, Section 225-a

Freedom of Information and Open Meetings laws,

Public Officers Law, Articles 6 & 7

Emergency Services (20)

PROGRAM AREA AND SERVICES:

PUBLIC HEALTH & SAFETY

The Department of Emergency Services (DES) is comprised of four Divisions: Fire Services; Emergency Communications Center (60 Control); Emergency Medical Services (EMS); and Emergency Management (EM).

Fire Service/Training:

- ✓ Coordinates fire training programs and seminars including educational and practical hands-on skill evolutions utilizing live fire simulations.
- ✓ Performs fire inspections of all County facilities to ensure employee and visitor safety.
- ✓ Maintains and coordinates County Fire Mutual Aid planning and emergency scene support through County Deputy Fire Coordinators and DES staff members.
- ✓ Manages the County's specialized Hazardous Materials Response Team (HMRT); Technical Rescue Team (TRT); and the Grasslands Fire Brigade.
- ✓ Coordinates the activities of the County Arson Task Force; hosts meetings of the Arson Task Force Executive Board and provides oversight of the Cause and Origin (C&O) Arson Investigation Teams, and provides training for fire investigators.
- ✓ Oversees maintenance, new construction projects, and repairs to the training center and supporting facilities.
- ✓ Provides support to the Fire Advisory Board.
- ✓ Provides support to Emergency Operations Center (EOC) staffing.

Emergency Communications Center (ECC) "60 Control":

- ✓ Provides primary dispatch services for 54 of the 59 (92%) fire departments and 34 of the 49 (69%) EMS agencies that operate in County. Coordinates all Fire and EMS Mutual Aid for requests in and out of county for assistance utilizing Computer Aided Dispatch (CAD) equipment and radio communications systems.

- ✓ Dispatches specialized response resources: Field Communications Unit (FC1), Portable Radio Towers, Mass Decontamination Units, Weapons of Mass Destruction (WMD) squads, Mass Casualty Incident (MCI) Trailers, HMRT, TRT, C&O, Fire and EMS Mutual Aid Coordinators, as well as Emergency Management personnel and equipment.
- ✓ Trained to perform Emergency Medical Dispatch (EMD) that includes providing pre-arrival medical instruction offered to callers so life saving medical care can be initiated prior to the first responders arrival. The program includes an effective Quality Assurance/Quality Improvement program.
- ✓ Coordinates communications system utilization and supports special equipment needs during emergent and pre-planned events, including the use of radio patches, mobile communications unit, mobile tower sites, CAD, Westchester Radio Amateur Civil Emergency Services (RACES), and radio cache management.

Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Coordination-Training:

- ✓ Conducts specialty training programs in support of EMS provider continuing education requirements as well as skills maintenance and development.
- ✓ Supports the Westchester Regional EMS Council (WREMSCO) Program Agency and manages the day to day business of the Council and Regional Emergency Medical Advisory Committee (REMAC).
- ✓ Coordinate EMS Mutual Aid requests for long duration out of county EMS support and ensure the local day to day EMS needs are met in each community, including the provision of emergency scene support through the EMS Zone Coordinator program and DES team members.
- ✓ Administers Respiratory Fit Test Equipment Loaner Program that supports Fire, EMS, and Law Enforcement agencies' compliance with regulatory Respiratory Protection programs.
- ✓ Manages the County Public Access Defibrillations (PAD) program. Over 190 Automated External Defibrillators (AEDs) are located at County facilities such as offices, parks, and safety vehicles.

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- ✓ Manages the County's Cardio Pulmonary Resuscitation - Automated External Defibrillator (CPR/AED), and 'Stop The Bleed' Training Program. Over 1,700 County employees have been trained and retrained since the program's inception.
- ✓ Coordinates the Special Needs Registry and administrative partnership with the Hudson Valley United Way 2-1-1 to assist local and county planning for residents that may require special assistance during disasters.
- ✓ Provides support staff to the EMS Advisory Board.
- ✓ Coordinate the Basic Life Support - First Responder Program, including the day-to-day oversight of the Emergency Medical Technicians that provide vital services at many of the County Parks and support other County functions in an effort to provide immediate medical care when required. In addition, the program provides BLS First Responder services to Playland Park.

Emergency Management (EM):

- ✓ Coordinates emergency management preparedness, planning, hazard mitigation, response, and recovery for Westchester County including sustainment of associated training and exercise programs.
- ✓ Coordinates with local municipalities, emergency response agencies, utilities, hospitals and schools on a daily basis.
- ✓ Coordinates on a daily basis with emergency management counterparts in NYC, counties throughout the region, and State partners that include the New York State Office of Emergency Management (NYSOEM) and Federal agencies.
- ✓ Coordinates with American Red Cross, Community Emergency Response Team (CERT) programs and other disaster volunteer groups.
- ✓ Provides staff assistance to the Local Emergency Planning Committee (LEPC) on hazardous materials emergency preparedness.
- ✓ Manages the Westchester County EOC.
- ✓ Coordinates Hazard Mitigation and Disaster Recovery with County departments and local municipalities.

DEPARTMENT INITIATIVES:

NEW

Department Wide: (Moved to On-Going Initiatives)

- ✓ A new storage facility has been built on Walker Road to hold all of our vehicles and training equipment that is presently stored in the yard to keep them more secure and out of the elements. The relocation of vehicles and equipment has provided an additional safe space for training activities in the yard.

Fire Services/Training:

- ✓ Working on a capital project to replace 30 year old 6 Story Fire Training Tower Class A Burn Building which is used for live burn training and other various fire and police training.
- ✓ Creating arson training classes for required annual training needed to be a fire investigator.
- ✓ Researching solutions to staff our Special Operations volunteer teams as a solely volunteer response is not sustainable for the long term.
- ✓ Working with local business association to identify potential volunteers from appropriate industries (chemical, manufacturing) who could advise the HazMat team on incidents they are likely to respond to.
- ✓ Collaborating with the County Executive's Office, the Department of Environmental Facilities, and the Department of Consumer Protection to implement solutions to the growing concerns over Lithium Ion battery hazards to implement incident tracking, proper disposal of batteries, public education, and firefighter training.
- ✓ Work with municipalities, local first responders, schools, community organizations, etc., in partnership with DPS, to train and build local leadership command structures, response teams, and provide civilian Stop-the-Bleed and CPR training.
- ✓ Installing a new overhead garage bay door at our 4 Dana Road facility that we wish to be in place for the arrival of our new ladder truck. This will involve relocating our existing Firefighters Memorial to

Emergency Services (20)

a location in between the Fire and Police Training Centers and changing it to a First Responders Memorial that would include Fire, Police, and EMS.

- ✓ Provide resources to municipalities regarding Battery Energy Storage Systems.

Emergency Communications Center (ECC) “60 Control”:

- ✓ Continue to work on improving intercounty communications with the City of New York and Hudson Valley region as day to day and large scale emergencies can easily cross county borders.
- ✓ In partnership with the Department of Information Technology, continue to migrate the existing Computer Aided Dispatch (CAD) system hardware and software to a new platform. This will require significant setup, hardware, and training to allow for enhanced event accuracy, speed, and reliability
- ✓ Finalized the contract to replace the aged radio equipment used to support the national interoperability radio systems used in the county.
- ✓ Accepted delivery of a small utility vehicle that will be used to support our emergency communications division field response. This unit will be used to support the emergency services community when requested to provide on-site incident support.
- ✓ Received approval to design and replace the 2007 mobile Field Communications Unit.
- ✓ Provide radio system user training “Communications 101” to the emergency services community. This program will provide the background and tools needed to better understand and more effectively utilize the radio equipment used day to day by our county emergency responders.
- ✓ Work with the Emergency Services Communications Working Group, including fire, EMS, and Law Enforcement leadership to address common communication issues and create an improvement plan with this multidisciplinary group.
- ✓ Hire a consultant to provide a refresh on the exiting Tactical interoperability Communications Plan (TICP), Field Operations Guide (FOG), and Communication Assets Survey and Mapping Tool

(CASM), in addition to reviewing future planning for interoperability with our local and regional partners.

- ✓ Working on adding two tone detect in an effort to provide the fire and EMS dispatch customers with a backup means of enet notification.

Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Coordination-Training

- ✓ Continue to support collaborative Active Shooter Hostile Event (ASHE) awareness and tactical training programs.
- ✓ Manage the ongoing needs and utilization of the EMS Division Certified Basic Life Support First Responders (BLSFR) program. The staff now provides support to the Fire Division during live fire training, special County events and provides Playland Park with primary EMS First Response.
- ✓ Continue to perform a study through a contract with Fitch Associates to determine the best option for a long term, sustainable EMS system that will enable the county to meet the growing demand for EMS service.
- ✓ Included a new EMS position to oversee the division and support the ongoing training and planning efforts for EMS to better respond to an ASHE event.

Emergency Management (EM):

- ✓ Coordinate the efforts of county departments to develop a Continuity of Operations Plan for county government.
- ✓ Coordinate the process of an update to the County's Comprehensive Emergency Management Plan (CEMP) and of the organizational structure of the county EOC.
- ✓ Expand upon existing engagement between DES and DOH on preparedness for emerging infectious disease outbreaks (i.e. Ebola).
- ✓ Complete a project, in cooperation with DOIT, to upgrade the audio/visual system in the EOC, specifically the addition of video and audio conferencing capability throughout the workspace.
- ✓ Purchase and deploy a comprehensive inventory tracking and warehouse management platform to provide real-time inventory, order status and analytics for emergency supplies and equipment.

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- ✓ Begin the update process for the countywide Hazard Mitigation Plan, in partnership with the Planning Department, and in collaboration with local municipalities.
- ✓ Complete an update to the Hurricane Evacuation Study for the NYC-Metro region in cooperation with New York State DHSES, US Army Corps of Engineers, and FEMA.

DEPARTMENT INITIATIVES:

ON-GOING

Department Wide:

- ✓ WCDES is working in collaboration with the City of New Rochelle Youth Bureau (NRYB) and the New Rochelle Fire Department to support their Girls on Fire: Firefighter Program. The program provides job readiness skills training and actual work experience. This is a six (6) week program to learn about potential career opportunities in emergency services. Each DES Division introduces the girls to the different job opportunities of Emergency Services from firefighting, EMT and paramedic services, emergency management, and fire investigation.
- ✓ Social media campaigns and videos to promote Fire prevention and safety tips, Emergency preparedness and response, EMS activities, 60 Control accomplishments; participation in local Family Days to promote safety for kids and families.
- ✓ Developed and administering the Higher Education Recruitment and Retention Opportunities (HERRO) tuition and student loan reimbursement program designed to help volunteer fire departments and EMS agencies recruit and retain volunteers; approved volunteers are eligible for up to \$6,000 annually in tuition reimbursement or student loan repayment assistance.
- ✓ The successful program awarded 162 applicants in the 2023 fiscal year, and as of mid-August, has awarded 101 applicants for the 2024 fiscal year.
- ✓ Continue to deliver Firefighter I programs through several types of schedules to meet the needs of volunteers; i.e. night/weekend, blended (online) learning, and summer daytime schedules.
- ✓ Continue to work in partnership with the Westchester County Municipal Training Officers and NYSOFPD to provide monthly training sessions for the career fire service to assist departments in meeting the NYSOFPD 427.7 standards.
- ✓ Partner with Con Edison to develop a new training prop and curriculum that simulates over 30 different types of gas emergencies that firefighters may encounter.
- ✓ Continue to develop regional coordination and response capabilities associated through the NYS Hazardous Materials Targeted Grant Program for state funding that includes Dutchess, Putnam and Westchester County teams.
- ✓ Maintain, store and track resources to support the Hazardous Materials and Technical Rescue response, including monitoring and detection, mitigation and decontamination.
- ✓ Coordinate and support capital projects to rehabilitate training structures, training yard, main facility and equipment storage building.
- ✓ Continue to work with individual fire departments to ensure compliance with the OSHA Best Practices for the fire service.
- ✓ Established and maintain the Fallen Firefighter Memorial Committee to oversee the process of the Fallen Firefighter Monument and the addition of names.
- ✓ Continue to coordinate the Westchester County ASHE Integrated Response Committee to develop more training programs and template of standard operational guidelines for each emergency response discipline to standardized procedures for response to these types of incidents county-wide. Also began to include civil unrest situations as one additional hostile event item to be added to training programs.

Fire Services/Training:

- ✓ Host and support the Yonkers and Career Fire Chiefs Association's Academies each year.

Emergency Communications Center (ECC) "60 Control":

- ✓ In coordination with DoIT, support and continue to buildout the countywide radio communications systems that provide services to

Emergency Services (20)

fire, EMS, police headquarters, hospitals and the county bus transportation system. This system provides voice communications and alerting for a majority of the fire and EMS agencies in the county.

- ✓ Maintain and coordinate emergency communication systems and equipment, plans and procedures during special pre-planned events, exercises and large scale emergency responses including a Field Communications Unit, transportable radio towers and portable radio caches.
- ✓ Coordinate and support activities with RACES amateur radio operators and facilitate maintenance and enhancement of radio equipment.
- ✓ Work with the New York City Interagency Communications Committee, Hudson Valley Interoperability Communications Consortium and the New York State Communications Interoperability Working Group, to develop plans and partnerships to enhance awareness and ability to communicate across county borders.

Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Coordination-Training:

- ✓ Maintain Hospital-EMS Diversion Program/Website.
- ✓ Ongoing support of the 50 EMS agencies that operate in the county.
- ✓ Support ongoing specialty EMS training and MCI preparedness, Active Assailant response through the sustainment and enhancement of supply and equipment resources.
- ✓ Support the WREMSCO and REMAC initiatives including Advanced Life Support provider credentialing and the annual EMS awards ceremony
- ✓ Sustain an enhanced protocol with United Way 2-1-1 to update and maintain the Special Needs registry.
- ✓ Support the county's PAD program to include adult and pediatric CPR, utilization of an AED, and how to utilize the Stop the Bleed (Hartford Consensus) supplies provided as part of the AED equipment.
- ✓ Support the County's EMS BLSFR program which provides EMTs to County Parks and other County properties and programs when

needed. The team provides immediate access to emergency healthcare services during events.

Emergency Management (EM):

- ✓ Continue to conduct training and exercise activities to support readiness for major emergencies.
- ✓ Continue to host various emergency management meetings for County departments, municipal officials, non-county organizations and hospitals to facilitate disaster planning and response coordination.
- ✓ Continue to maintain emergency preparedness information, including informational programs for the County website, printed materials and delivery of preparedness presentations.
- ✓ Continue to maintain the DisasterLAN/Westchester Incident Management System (WIMS) application, including delivery of user training.
- ✓ Continue to work with Westchester County Department of Health (DOH) on public health emergency preparedness.
- ✓ Continue to partner with DPS on Homeland Security related programs and preparedness.
- ✓ Continue to maintain a comprehensive Multi-Jurisdiction/Multi-Hazard Mitigation Plan, identifying hazards to which the County is vulnerable and identifying strategies to mitigate the potential impacts.
- ✓ Continue to coordinate efforts to enhance emergency preparedness for people with disabilities and others with access and functional needs in cooperation with multiple County departments and external stakeholders including ongoing support of the Disabilities Emergency Preparedness Advisory Committee, co-chaired by Emergency Management and the Office for People with Disabilities.
- ✓ Continue to coordinate ongoing disaster recovery from Hurricane Sandy, Tropical Storm Isaias, the remnants of Hurricane Ida, DR-4755/September 2023 Flooding, and COVID-19 including acting as a liaison between County departments, New York State and FEMA. Working in cooperation with the Budget Department, millions of dollars have been received from FEMA for county government's

Emergency Services (20)

disaster recovery related eligible expenses since 2012, and continued recovery work will increase that amount.

- ✓ Transition the County Radiological Emergency Preparedness (REP) Program for the Indian Point Energy Center to reflect Indian Point as a defueled nuclear power plant in decommissioning.
- ✓ Continue to work cooperatively with DOIT with the development and deployment of a new emergency notification, public alert and warning platform, to communicate with employees, municipal officials, emergency management stakeholders, and the public during emergencies.

DEPARTMENT ACCOMPLISHMENTS:

NEW

Fire Service/Training:

- ✓ 2024 Year-to-Date: Assisted in the successful graduation of 30 Yonkers Career Firefighters and 32 other career firefighters from 17 different departments from 4 counties (Westchester, Dutchess, Nassau, and Orange). Hosting an additional academy in the fall with approximately 45 firefighters from 17 different departments from 4 counties (Westchester, Dutchess, Nassau, and Orange).
- ✓ Deployed new training curriculum for emergency responders to respond to an Active Shooter or Hostile Action for both hands on victim care and a stand-alone class for Incident Commanders; approximately 300 fire, police, and EMS trained to date.
- ✓ New monthly training class for fire fighters on different topics ranging from kitchen fires, high-rise fires, commanding an initial response.
- ✓ Publicized fire prevention and education programs through our social media platform on some of the following subjects; lithium-ion battery safety, summer safety tips, home heating safety and other important topics.

Emergency Communications Center (ECC) “60 Control”:

- ✓ Purchased additional trailer mounted generators to support the needs of the radio system towers, when the primary units fail or require service.

- ✓ Included Law Enforcement in the Emergency Services Communications Working Group (ESCWG) to enhance interoperability with all the primary emergency services providers.
- ✓ Worked on streaming audio of the Fire/EMS talk group through Broadcastify.

Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Coordination-Training:

- ✓ Included the Department of Probation in the CPR, AED, Stop-the-Bleed hemorrhage control training.
- ✓ Phoenix achieved national certification as a First Responder Therapy Dog.

Emergency Management (EM):

- ✓ Developed a Protective Action Matrix for Air Quality in cooperation with the Health Department.
- ✓ Secured contractor support for all-hazards emergency preparedness support, including development of a new countywide Comprehensive Emergency Management Plan.
- ✓ Secured contractor support for all-hazards emergency preparedness support, including development of a new countywide Comprehensive Emergency Management Plan.
- ✓ Secured contractor support for development of a Continuity of Operations Plan for county government.
- ✓ Completed the Hazard Identification and Vulnerability Assessment phases of an update to the Hurricane Evacuation Study for the NYC-Metro region, in cooperation with New York State DHSES, US Army Corps of Engineers and FEMA.
- ✓ Hosted an Emergency Action Planning Workshop for Dam Owners and local officials in cooperation with New York State DEC.
- ✓ Worked with New York State DHSES to receive a Major Disaster Declaration for flooding that occurred in September of 2023, allowing for reimbursement for eligible expenses and damages for local communities and county government.

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DEPARTMENT ACCOMPLISHMENTS:

ON-GOING

Fire Service/Training:

- ✓ Conducted 290 Fire Inspections of County property and facilities in 2023.
- ✓ Grasslands Fire Brigade responded to 60 weekday fire alarms and incidents on the Grasslands Campus and maintained training requirements to sustain brigade member skills in 2023.
- ✓ HazMat and Technical Rescue teams responded to approximately 63 incidents in the County through mutual aid.
- ✓ Provided 125,620 hours of fire training in 2023.
- ✓ The County Fire Coordinator and Deputy Fire Coordinators provided assistance at 350 emergency scenes in 2023.
- ✓ C&O team members responded to 140 incidents in 2023 to assist local Fire Chiefs in the determination of the origin and causation as required of them by General Municipal Law 204 (d).
- ✓ Developed and hosted a Weapons of Mass Destruction "WMD Squad" four day training and one day drill for 200 firefighters in 2023.

Emergency Communications Center (ECC) "60 Control":

- ✓ Provision of dispatch services that includes handling 204,561 phone calls and processing 163,491 CAD entries in 2023.

Emergency Medical Services (EMS) Coordination-Training:

- ✓ Provided the Respiratory Protection and Fit Testing equipment through a loaner program to Fire, EMS, Law Enforcement and non-county agencies throughout the County.
- ✓ Supported the development of virtual web based training and call audits so providers can meet their educational requirements.
- ✓ Supported the dissemination of Personal Protective Equipment, training and best practices in treatment of patients presenting with COVID.

- ✓ Assisted the EMS agencies in the county with implementing electronic medical reporting mandated by the NYS DOH.
- ✓ Added hand sanitizer stations outside of all our training classrooms and in several other areas around our building to help prevent the spread of COVID-19 and other illnesses.
- ✓ Purchased sanitizing & UV decontamination systems that can be moved between classrooms and other areas of our facility to disinfect high traffic areas daily.

Emergency Management (EM):

- ✓ National Incident Management System (NIMS) related activities accounted for 3,050 participant hours in 2023, and included training, drills and EOC activations and other activities to implement NIMS and the Incident Command System in Westchester.
- ✓ An additional 492 hours were committed to training, exercise and other activities related to Disaster Volunteer Programs in 2023.
- ✓ Update of emergency plans and procedures including the Comprehensive Emergency Management Plan, Radiological Emergency Response Plan for Indian Point, and the Severe Weather Concept of Operations, and guidance documents related to the EOC.

REVENUES:

- ✓ Revenue is generated through the services provided by the Grasslands Fire Brigade servicing the Grasslands Campus, through fire inspections provided throughout county owned facilities, and through CPR classes provided to county employees.
- ✓ Federal Emergency Management Act (FEMA) monies are received in support of staff salaries and program expenses as related to Emergency Management & Emergency Services.
- ✓ Revenue is received through Chapter 708 of New York State Laws relating to nuclear reactor assessments for radiological preparedness planning.
- ✓ Receive revenue from both Standard Amusement, LLC and the Parks Department for utilizing our EMTs to support the county EMS services at Playland Park and other county PARKS events.